



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Saint Augustine School
School Website: <https://augustinems.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School

URL audited: <https://bishopreicher.com/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School (PreK–12) shows strong classical alignment in its religious and metaphysical foundations and in its stated purposes (formation in virtue; pursuit of what is true, good, and beautiful). The curriculum reflects elements of the Catholic liberal arts tradition with theology, sacred scripture, Latin, and classical literature in the program. However, there is limited public evidence of distinctively classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, formal rhetoric training, chanting/recitation, scholé) and little articulation of a classical faculty culture. The site also emphasizes modern/STEM and “21st-century skills” initiatives, which dilute classical signals. In aggregate, the school reads as classical in foundation and intention but mixed in execution and articulation—thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key strengths - Robust Catholic formation with weekly Mass, Eucharistic devotion, catechesis, and explicit virtue formation (prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance), with repeated appeals to truth, goodness, and beauty . - Curriculum includes theology, classical literature, Latin, and classic authors (e.g., Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare) consistent with a Great Books orientation .

Key growth areas - Publicly document classical pedagogy (Socratic discussion, dialectic, rhetoric capstones, chanting/recitation in the lower grades, scholé/restful learning), and articulate a classical faculty culture and formation plan. - Balance technology/STEM messaging with clear, primary commitments to liberal arts, Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, and the Great Conversation per the keyword framework in Six Essential Elements and lexicon .

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on school site: - “Catholic liberal arts tradition,” “classical learning,” “timeless truths,” “love for what is true, good, and beautiful” - “four-year theology program,” “sacred scripture,” “moral and sacramental life” - “daily prayer,” “weekly Mass,” “Eucharist,” “students ... saints and scholars” - “Catechesis of the Good Shepherd,” “Scripture, liturgy, and prayer,” “Atrium (sacred space)” - “Virtues Program ... prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance ... faith, hope, charity” - Mapping to Six Elements positive/negative lexicon: - Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; sacred scripture; catechesis; liturgy; Mass/Eucharist; prayer—explicit matches to Religious Foundations and Goal keywords in the Six Elements document and lexicon . - Negative matches: none (no relativism/value-neutral signals found). - Quantification: - Positive hits: +15 (truth/goodness/beauty x2 pages; virtue/virtues; theology; scripture; sacramental life; Mass/Eucharist; catechesis; liturgy; prayer) - Negative

hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Estimated coverage of sub□criteria: 0.95 (all three sub□elements evidenced: moral realism, theology, liturgical/communal practices)

Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: The school explicitly grounds education in virtue and the transcendentals; integrates theology across HS program; and practices weekly liturgy and catechesis—hallmarks of classical religious foundations per the Six Elements framework .

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on school site: - “form students into virtuous disciples of Christ ... Education in Virtue” - “love for what is true, good, and beautiful,” “forming both the intellect and the soul,” “live virtuously” - “spiritual formation” (MS program) - College□prep language: “PSAT,” “National Merit,” “AP Calculus,” “college applications” - “21st century ... technology” (Tech Program) - Mapping to Six Elements positive/negative lexicon: - Positive: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; formation; pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty—core to classical purpose . - Negative: “college and career ready,” “21st□century skills” signals appear in the negative keyword lists for purpose and curriculum orientation . - Quantification: - Positive hits: +12 (virtue/formation/true□good□beautiful across several pages) - Negative hits: -5 (college□prep/PSAT/AP/National Merit/21st□century) - Percent positive: 0.71 - Estimated coverage of sub□criteria: 0.85 (all three ideals evidenced; some dilution by college□prep emphasis)

Rating: CLASSICAL (low confidence) to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Final decision: CLASSICAL, because the site repeatedly prioritizes formation in virtue and the transcendentals as the telos, though messaging is mixed with college□prep and 21st□century language. The classical signals remain primary in mission framing per the Six Elements criteria .

Element 3: School Curriculum

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on school site: - “Catholic liberal arts tradition,” “classical learning,” “classical literature,” “Latin,” “philosophy,” “theology,” “sacred music” - Classic authors: “Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare ... Dickens, Austen, Fitzgerald” (Great Books orientation) - STEM/Tech: “Robotics ... hands□on learning,” “STEM fields,” “Google Classroom,” “21st century” - Mapping to Six Elements positive/negative lexicon: - Positive: liberal arts, classical literature, Latin, engagement with primary/Great Books authors align with classical curriculum indicators . - Negative: STEM□first/21st□century framing and tech□forward rhetoric are listed as negative indicators when dominant . - Gaps: No explicit public mention of the Trivium/Quadrivium by name; no explicit “Great Books” label; no explicit “history (vs social studies)” signal. - Quantification: - Positive hits: +9 (liberal arts/classical literature/Latin/theology/philosophy/classic authors/sacred music) - Negative hits: -4 (STEM fields, hands□on/experiential framing, Google Classroom/digital learning, 21st□century) - Percent positive: 0.69 - Estimated coverage of sub□criteria: 0.60 (Great Books implied via authors; Latin evident; theology/philosophy evident; explicit Trivium/Quadrivium and “history not social studies” not evidenced)

Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Justification: Strong Catholic liberal arts and classical literature/Latin presence, but public articulation lacks Trivium/Quadrivium and Great Books language, and the tech/STEM emphasis competes for primacy per the lexicon’s negative list .

Element 4: School Pedagogy (Teaching Methods)

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on school site: - Positive classical pedagogy terms (Socratic, dialectic, seminar, rhetoric orations; chanting/recitation; scholé/restful learning): not evidenced on site pages reviewed. - Liturgical rhythm and catechesis integrated in school life (weekly Mass, catechesis) - Negative signals: “hands-on learning” (experiential), “student-centered approach,” “21st century skills” - Mapping to Six Elements positive/negative lexicon: - Positive targets include Socratic seminar, chanting/recitation, restful learning (scholé), imitation/progymnasmata—none surfaced publicly. - Negative targets include experiential/project-based/student-directed/21st-century skills language—some of which is present. - Quantification: - Positive hits: +1 (catechesis integrated—tangential to pedagogy, but signals formation) - Negative hits: -3 (hands-on/experiential; student-centered; 21st century) - Percent positive: 0.25 - Estimated coverage of subcriteria: 0.20 (little to no public evidence of Socratic/seminar/recitation/scholé/rhetoric capstones)

Rating: NOT CLASSICAL

Justification: The site does not articulate hallmark classical methods; several negative pedagogical indicators appear in program messaging per the Six Elements lexicon.

Element 5: Faculty

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on school site: - Public descriptors of faculty as models/mentors, “living curriculum,” collegial classical culture, or “portrait of a teacher”: not found. - Administrative/staff listings present but not missionally framed to classical faculty ideals. - Mapping to Six Elements positive/negative lexicon: - Positive: teachers as virtuous models/mentors; collegiality in classical inquiry; faculty formation—not evidenced publicly. - Negative: facilitator/constructivist jargon—not present, but absence of positive articulation remains. - Quantification: - Positive hits: +0 - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 0.00 - Estimated coverage of subcriteria: 0.10 (no explicit classical faculty philosophy published)

Rating: NOT CLASSICAL

Justification: There is no public statement of a classical faculty ideal or formation, as required by the Six Elements criteria.

Element 6: Parents and Community

Mandatory keyword analysis - Keywords/phrases found on school site: - “partnership between home and school,” “family-centered community” (preschool communications) and “parents appreciate how [Virtues] program extends beyond the classroom ... bring these teachings home” (home-formation tie-in). - Open House invitations—community welcome. - Mapping to Six Elements positive/negative lexicon: - Positive: partnership with parents; parent formation; home-school synergy—at least partially evidenced. - Negative: consumer language/minimal parent formation—not present. - Quantification: - Positive hits: +4 (parent partnership; family-centered; home carryover; open house hospitality) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Estimated coverage of subcriteria: 0.55 (partnership present; explicit parent education/book studies/open campus policies not articulated)

Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Justification: Clear partnership language and at-home virtue formation cues; more parent education artifacts would strengthen alignment per the Six Elements community criteria.

Aggregate Rating

- Religious & Metaphysical: CLASSICAL (1.00 pos; 0.95 coverage)
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL (0.71 pos; 0.85 coverage)
- Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (0.69 pos; 0.60 coverage)
- Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL (0.25 pos; 0.20 coverage)
- Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL (0.00 pos; 0.10 coverage)
- Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (1.00 pos; 0.55 coverage)

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school's Catholic□classical foundations (telos, theology, liturgy, virtues, Latin, classical literature) are clearly present and strong, consistent with the Six Essential Elements keyword framework and lexicon. However, missing public articulation of classical pedagogy and faculty formation—combined with prominent tech/STEM/21st□century language—keeps the aggregate from being fully CLASSICAL at this time .

What would move the needle (to CLASSICAL)

- Publish a clear pedagogy page:
 - Name Socratic seminar/dialectic in upper school; debate, disputation, and formal rhetoric capstones/orations; describe progymnasmata and imitation as method—aligning to the Pedagogy keywords .
 - For lower school, describe memory work, chanting/recitation, and singing as daily practices; reference scholé/restful learning and formation in wonder .
- Strengthen curriculum articulation:
 - Name the Trivium/Quadrivium; explicitly label Great Books and the Great Conversation; clarify “history” (not “social studies”), primary sources, and timeline work per the Curriculum keywords .
- Faculty formation:
 - Add a “Portrait of a Classical Teacher” and note ongoing faculty formation in classical pedagogy; highlight teachers as mentors/models, a “faculty of friends,” and collegial inquiry .
- Parent formation:
 - Offer (and publicize) parent seminars/book clubs on classical education; provide a parent covenant or similar articulation of shared formation .
- Re□balance messaging:
 - Keep STEM/tech language in its proper place; foreground liberal arts, virtue formation, and Great Books to ensure classical telos is primary, per negative/positive keyword guidance in the Six Elements .

Evidence Appendix (selected site citations)

- High School Program: four□year theology; classic literature (Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare, etc.); college□prep references (PSAT/AP/National Merit)
- Middle School: classical literature, Latin, daily prayer; weekly Mass; “saints and scholars” framing
- Academics overview: “Catholic liberal arts tradition ... classical learning ... love for what is true, good, and beautiful”
- Virtues Program (Education in Virtue): prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance; faith, hope, charity; application in home life
- Catechesis of the Good Shepherd: Scripture, liturgy, prayer; Atrium (sacred space)
- Technology/Robotics pages: hands□on learning; STEM language; “21st century” skills

Note: Keyword standards and positive/negative indicators are drawn from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the classicality lexicon used in this audit .

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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